

Word family: **neighbour / neighbours / neighbouring / neighbourhood / neighbourly**

Base word: neighbour

Plural: neighbours

Related forms: neighbouring, neighbourhood, neighbourly

American spelling: neighbor, neighbors, neighboring, neighborhood, neighborly

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞 , 較少見) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “One person I find genuinely interesting is my former **neighbour**, Mr. Wong...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **neighbour** means a **person who lives near you, especially in the same building, street, or local area**.

Mr. Wong used to live close to the speaker in the same apartment building.

繁體中文：***居住在自己住所附近、同一棟大樓、同一條街道或鄰近地區的人**

中文翻譯：

> “One person I find genuinely interesting is my former **neighbour**, Mr. Wong...”

「有一位我真心覺得很有趣的人，就是我以前的**鄰居**黃先生……」

Here:

neighbour = 居住在自己附近的人；鄰居

1. **neighbour = person living nearby (人物 / 住所) — 鄰居；鄰人**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A person who lives near another person, especially in the same building, street, or neighbourhood.

Practice 1 — Original

> “One person I find genuinely interesting is my former **neighbour**, Mr. Wong.”

「有一位我真心覺得很有趣的人，就是我以前的**鄰居**黃先生。」

Practice 2

> “Our new **neighbours** moved in last weekend.”

「我們的新**鄰居**上星期末搬了進來。」

Practice 3

> “She often chats with the **neighbour** who lives downstairs.”

「她經常和住在樓下的**鄰居**聊天。」

****neighbour = 居住在自己住所附近、同一大樓、街道或社區的人****

Common:

- * next-door neighbour
- * upstairs neighbour
- * downstairs neighbour
- * former neighbour
- * friendly neighbour

These are all one underlying residential sense.

2. ****neighbour = nearby country/place/organization (地方 / 國家) — 鄰近者；鄰國；鄰近地方****

****Neighbour** can extend beyond people and refer to a **country, region, organization, property, or other entity situated nearby**.**

Practice 4

> “Canada is the United States’ northern **neighbour**.”

「加拿大是美國北面的**鄰國**。」

Practice 5

> “The museum and its **neighbour**, the city library, share the same square.”

「博物館和它旁邊的**鄰近建築 / 鄰居**市立圖書館共用同一個廣場。」

****neighbour = 在地理位置上與另一個國家、地方、建築或單位相鄰的對象****

This is genuinely broader than the ordinary “person next door” sense.

For learners, the Chinese often changes naturally:

* country → 鄰國

* property/building → 鄰近單位 / 鄰近建築

* organization → 鄰近機構

3. ****neighbour** = nearby object in a sequence/system (相鄰項目) — 相鄰者；鄰接項******

In technical, mathematical, scientific, or computing contexts, ****neighbour**** can mean an item located next to another item in a sequence, structure, grid, network, or system.

Practice 6

> “Each square interacts with its immediate ****neighbours****.”

「每一個方格都會與它直接相鄰的****鄰接方格****互動。」

Practice 7

> “The algorithm compares each point with its nearest ****neighbours****.”

「這個演算法會把每個點與其最近的****相鄰點****作比較。」

****neighbour** = 在一個排列、網格、網絡或系統中位置最接近或直接相鄰的項目******

This is an established modern technical sense.

The Golden Manual allows domain-specific meanings when they are common enough and conceptually distinct.

4. ****neighbour** = person sharing nearby social/community space (社區成員) — 鄰里；附近居民******

Sometimes ****neighbour**** emphasizes social proximity and community membership more than exact physical next-door location.

Practice 8

> “The whole street came together to help an elderly ****neighbour****.”

「整條街的居民一起幫助一位年長的**鄰里 / 附近居民**。」

Practice 9

> “Good **neighbours** look out for one another.”

「好**鄰里**會互相照應。」

neighbour = 居住在同一社區或附近地區、與自己具有一定生活接觸的人

For database counting, I would **merge this with Meaning 1**, because the underlying concept remains:

> **a person living nearby**

The emphasis simply shifts from physical location to community relationship.

Related form: **neighbouring**

Neighbouring means situated near or next to something.

Practice 10

> “They visited several **neighbouring** villages.”

「他們參觀了幾個**鄰近的**村莊。」

Practice 11

> “The fire spread to a **neighbouring** building.”

「火勢蔓延到一座**鄰近的**建築物。」

neighbouring = 位於附近、相鄰或與另一地方接近的

Related form: **neighbourhood**

Neighbourhood has two particularly useful meanings.

neighbourhood = local residential area (社區 / 附近地區) — 社區 ; 一帶

Practice 12

> “It is a quiet residential **neighbourhood**.”

「那是一個安靜的住宅**社區**。」

Practice 13

> “There are several cafés in the **neighbourhood**.”

「這個**附近地區 / 社區**有幾間咖啡店。」

****neighbourhood** = 由住宅、街道和附近設施構成的一個本地社區或區域**

**neighbourhood = approximate amount/area (大約範圍) — 大約；附近範圍**

In the expression:

> ****in the neighbourhood of****

it can mean approximately.

Practice 14

> “The repair will cost ****in the neighbourhood of**** \$5,000.”

「維修費用大約會在****五千元左右****。」

Practice 15

> “The population is ****in the neighbourhood of**** two million.”

「人口大約在****二百萬左右****。」

****in the neighbourhood of + number** = 大約在某個數字附近；約莫**

This is a useful fixed expression, not a core meaning of ****neighbour**** itself.

Related form: ****neighbourly****

****Neighbourly**** means friendly, helpful, and considerate toward people living nearby.

Practice 16

> “It was very ****neighbourly**** of him to help carry the boxes.”

「他幫忙搬箱子，真是十分****有鄰里互助精神 / 友善熱心****。」

Practice 17

> “They have always been warm and ****neighbourly****.”

「他們一直都很****友善，而且很有鄰里互助精神****。」

****neighbourly = 對鄰居友善、願意幫助及互相照應的****

Verb use: ****neighbour = be next to / border (相鄰) — 與.....相鄰****

As a verb, ****neighbour**** can mean to be situated next to or near something.

This is much less common in everyday conversation than the noun.

Practice 18

> “The property ****neighbours**** a public park.”

「這個物業****毗鄰 / 與一個公園相鄰****。」

Practice 19

> “The region ****neighbours**** several major cities.”

「這個地區****鄰近****幾個主要城市。」

****neighbour something = 位於某地方旁邊或與其相鄰****

Register:

****less common / somewhat formal****

For ordinary learners, ****border****, ****be next to****, or ****be near**** are often more natural depending on context.

Important distinction: ****neighbour vs nearby person****

neighbour

usually implies that the person **lives near you**.

nearby person

only means someone physically close at that moment.

For example:

> “A nearby person helped me.”

does not necessarily mean:

> “My neighbour helped me.”

So **neighbour** normally refers to an ongoing residential relationship, not merely temporary physical proximity.

Important distinction: **neighbour vs roommate / flatmate**

neighbour

lives nearby but usually in a different home/unit.

roommate / flatmate

shares the same home or room.

> “My neighbour lives next door.”

> “My flatmate lives in the same flat.”

So:

neighbour = 鄰居

flatmate/roommate = 室友 / 同住者

Important distinction: **neighbour vs resident**

resident

= anyone who lives in a particular place or area

neighbour

= someone who lives near a particular person or property

A person may be:

> a resident of the building

without necessarily being:

> your immediate neighbour

The reference point matters.

Important distinction: **neighbour vs neighbourhood**

neighbour

= person/entity nearby

neighbourhood

= the surrounding local area/community

> “My neighbour is friendly.”

「我的鄰居很友善。」

> “My neighbourhood is quiet.”

「我住的社區很安靜。」

This is a key family distinction.

Important distinction: **neighbouring vs nearby**

These overlap strongly.

neighbouring

often emphasizes:

> directly adjacent or part of the immediately surrounding area

nearby

simply means:

> not far away

> “a neighbouring country”

often means a country sharing or closely adjoining a border.

> “a nearby country”

only means geographically close.

So **neighbouring** can imply a stronger adjacency relationship.

British / American spelling note

Your passage uses British English:

* **neighbour**

* **neighbours**

* **neighbouring**

* **neighbourhood**

American English normally uses:

* **neighbor**

* **neighbors**

* **neighboring**

* **neighborhood**

The meaning does not change.

The Golden Manual specifically says useful British/American variants should be flagged when relevant.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **neighbour / neighbor**
- * **neighbours / neighbors**
- * **neighbouring / neighboring**
- * **neighbourhood / neighborhood**
- * **neighbourly / neighborly**

Useful compounds and expressions include:

- * next-door neighbour
- * neighbouring country
- * neighbouring building
- * neighbourhood
- * in the neighbourhood of
- * neighbourly behaviour

This family is useful because it moves naturally from:

> **a nearby person/entity**

to:

> **a nearby area**

and:

> **friendly behaviour toward nearby residents**

The Golden Manual says useful derivational and lexical family members should be included when they add practical vocabulary value, while still being labelled accurately.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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neighbour — person living nearby	居住在自己住所附近、同一大樓、街道或社區的人
neighbour — nearby country/place/entity	在地理位置上與另一個國家、地方、建築或單位相鄰的對象
neighbour — adjacent item in a system	在排列、網格、網絡或其他系統中與另一項直接相

鄰或位置最接近的項目		
neighbour — verb		位於某個地方旁邊、鄰近或與其相鄰；較少見 / 較正式
neighbouring		位於附近、相鄰或緊接另一地方的
neighbourhood		由住宅、街道及附近設施構成的一個本地社區或區域
neighbourly		對鄰居友善、願意幫助及互相照應的
in the neighbourhood of		大約在某個數字或數量附近；約莫

For your original sentence

> “One person I find genuinely interesting is my former ****neighbour****, Mr. Wong...”

The exact meaning is:

****neighbour = 居住在自己附近的人****

More specifically:

****former neighbour = 以前曾經住在自己附近、與自己屬於鄰居關係，但現在已不再是鄰居的人****

So:

> ****my former neighbour****

= ****我以前的鄰居****

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely distinct core meanings**** for ****neighbour****:

1. ****a person who lives nearby****
2. ****a nearby or adjoining country/place/entity****
3. ****an adjacent item/node/object in a technical or structured system****

I would treat ****neighbour as a verb**** as a useful low-priority grammatical extension rather than necessarily create a fourth major learner-facing sense, and keep ****neighbouring, neighbourhood, neighbourly**** as family extensions.